

Topic Listening

Climate change



THE LONDON SCHOOL
OF ECONOMICS AND
POLITICAL SCIENCE ■

Before you listen



You are going to listen to LSE academics discussing the questions below. Before you listen, share your views with a partner.

- A. How can we transform our economies to reduce the impacts of economic activity on the planet?
- B. How must our cities and transport systems be transformed to avoid climate catastrophe?
- C. How can we transition our economies and societies away from fossil fuels?
- D. Can we transform how we use and preserve land and prevent deforestation to ensure that our ecosystems flourish?

Listening



- Your teacher will divide you into four groups: A, B, C & D.
- Listen to the video for your group (see the next few slides) and take notes.
- You will either need to use headphones or find a place outside the classroom to listen.
- You may need to listen more than once.

A: How can we transform our economies to reduce the impacts of economic activity on the planet?



B: How must our cities and transport systems be transformed to avoid climate catastrophe?



C: How can we transition our economies and societies away from fossil fuels?



D: Can we transform how we use and preserve land and prevent deforestation to ensure that our ecosystems flourish?



After listening 1



- Share your notes with the other people in your group.
- What did the academics say? Do you agree with them?
- Was there any vocabulary that was confusing, useful, interesting...?
- How easy (or difficult) were the academics to understand? (They all have different speaking styles and accents)
- How will you summarise what you heard to someone in another group?

After listening 2



Find someone from another group and share summaries. Repeat until you have summaries for all of the groups.

- A. How can we transform our economies to reduce the impacts of economic activity on the planet?
- B. How must our cities and transport systems be transformed to avoid climate catastrophe?
- C. How can we transition our economies and societies away from fossil fuels?
- D. Can we transform how we use and preserve land and prevent deforestation to ensure that our ecosystems flourish?

Use the information you have heard to complete this table



Possible Solution	Benefits	Challenges
Carbon tax	Incentivises good behaviour	May have negative impacts on some groups; needs public support
Electric vehicles		
Self-driving vehicles		
Solar energy		
Hydro power		
Bio-fuels		
Forest carbon markets		

Use the information you have heard to complete this table



<i>Possible Solution</i>	<i>Benefits</i>	<i>Challenges</i>
<i>Carbon tax</i>	<i>Incentivises good behaviour</i>	<i>May have negative impacts on some groups; needs public support</i>
<i>Electric vehicles</i>	<i>Easier to make than combustion engines</i>	<i>May be pricey, need appropriate facilities</i>
<i>Self-driving vehicles</i>	<i>May reduce the number of cars necessary and the amount of road space required</i>	<i>Will change land use; May increase road use.</i>
<i>Solar energy</i>	<i>Clean, renewable, effective</i>	<i>Need to think about diffusion</i>
<i>Hydro power</i>	<i>Clean, renewable, effective</i>	<i>Large dams are costly, risky and may displace communities</i>
<i>Bio-fuels</i>	<i>Alternatives to fossil fuel</i>	<i>Effectiveness is unclear; May result in 'green grabbing'.</i>
<i>Forest carbon markets</i>	<i>Offsets carbon use</i>	<i>May result in 'green grabbing'</i>

In the topic input, we discussed the importance of message framing.

Choose one of the solutions from the table and think about how it could be framed positively and negatively.

For example:

- Carbon taxes encourage innovation in green energy.
- Carbon taxes have a disproportionate impact on low-income groups.

Additional listening



If you would like to do some more listening, listen to the Reith Lecture “From Climate Crisis to Real Prosperity” by Mark Carney (audio and transcript on Moodle)

